

**World's ugliest dog**

In a battle of epics, Martha, a 3-year-old Neapolitan Mastiff has officially been crowned the 'World's ugliest Dog' <http://digit.in/Baddog>

**iPhone – Too hot to handle**

An iPhone 6s was found completely melted after the owner carelessly left under direct sunlight for an hour in the car. <http://digit.in/HotPhone>

(En)crypt the Change

Whether you like it or not, startups are at the centre of India's potential cryptocurrency revolution

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If you would've asked us about bitcoins a year back, many of us would've answered that it's a decentralised currency maintained via a public ledger system. Cut to the present, that technical definition is flagrantly inadequate in explaining the significance of bitcoin, or cryptocurrency for that matter. To give you a sense of the current situation, today Bitcoin is valued at ₹1.75 lacs. That is, one bitcoin can get you an Acer Predator 17 OR a Digit High End Gaming Rig (and still have about enough to buy a Samsung Galaxy S8 Plus). To put that number into context, roughly five years ago one bitcoin wouldn't even buy you a Raspberry Pi.

And this is not just a broad view of the entire world – the scenario in India is picking up pace too. There has been a rapid rate of growth in cryptocurrency transaction, as well as the number of startups that are involved in it. According to Dr. Chitral Patel, Growth Officer, Zebpay, India has witnessed a 250% growth in bitcoin userbase post demonetisation. In fact, their very own bitcoin wallet app, Zebpay, has reportedly crossed 500,000 users and is adding about 4,500 new ones every day. All



of this is bringing a distinct change in India's perception towards bitcoin.

THE CHANGE

"Currently there are more than 10 lakhs Indian citizens who are aware of cryptocurrency and (are) involve(d) in bitcoin trading.", says Mr. Hesham Rehman- CO-Founder & CEO, Bitxoxo,



DABFI can effectively pave the road for cryptocurrency

"In next 2-3 years this figure will reach nearly 10-15 million users. In view of these surging numbers of users, the Indian Government established a committee to look into ways of regulating the trading of Bitcoins and other cryptocurrencies in the country. These developments substantiate the growth of Bitcoin usage in India."

Even if there has been a lack of strong initiative from the government, startups have taken it upon themselves to set up the administrative infrastructure that the cryptocurrency market in India needs. Startups Zebpay, Unocoin, Coinsecure, Bitxoxo and SearchTrade have joined hands to form Digital Asset and Blockchain Foundation of India (DABFI) – an organising body to form regulations for the nascent industry. Their aim is to develop norms for trading of bitcoins and other blockchain-based digital assets.